NeonKey
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Your Wi-Fi & Network Checkup

A free 30-minute self-check for your home or small business, from NeonKey

Who it's for: anyone who wants a safer Wi-Fi network at home or at work. No technical background needed.
What you need: a phone or computer connected to your Wi-Fi, access to the sticker on your router, a password manager (or somewhere safe to note new passwords), and about 30 minutes when a few minutes offline won't bother anyone.
How it works: go step by step and tick one box for each: Already good, Fixed it, or Need help.

> **Before you change anything:** write down your current settings. Changing your Wi-Fi name or password will disconnect your devices, so have the new password ready to type in. If a step looks unfamiliar or you're unsure, skip it and mark "Need help".

1 Getting into the router's admin page

Find the sticker on your router. It usually lists the settings page address (often **192.168.0.1** or **192.168.1.1**) and a default login. Type that address into a browser while connected to your Wi-Fi, or scan the QR code if your router uses a phone app. If the sticker password still works, change it to something long and random and save it in a password manager. If your internet provider supplied the router, some settings may be locked; change what you can and ask them about the rest.

Why it matters: If the sticker password still works, anyone walking past the router can get in. Changing it is the most important fix on this list.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Notes: _____

2 Firmware updates

Firmware is the software that runs the router. Check the installed version, its release date, and whether automatic updates are available. If they are, turn them on. Updates usually restart the router, so don't unplug it mid-update. If the firmware is years old and new versions have stopped, budget for a replacement.

Why it matters: Security fixes only reach you if updates get installed.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Notes: _____

3 Your Wi-Fi name and password

Your Wi-Fi name (SSID) shouldn't include the router brand or model, your name or your address; boring is best. Your Wi-Fi password is separate from the admin password: a few random words make a strong passphrase that's easy to type. If past staff or neighbors have it, change it, but do it last, since every device must rejoin.

Why it matters: A plain name gives strangers fewer clues, and a long passphrase is much harder to guess.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Notes: _____

4 Security type: WPA3, WPA2 and the pairing button

In the wireless settings, choose Wi-Fi Protected Access 3 (WPA3) if you can. WPA2 is still acceptable with a strong password, and mixed mode (WPA2/WPA3) is a practical pick if you have older devices. If you see WEP or "Open" (no password), change it straight away. Turn off push-button pairing (Wi-Fi Protected Setup, or WPS).

Why it matters: The security type scrambles your Wi-Fi traffic so people nearby can't read it. Push-button pairing has known weaknesses, and anyone near the router can press it.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Notes: _____

5 A guest network for visitors and smart gadgets

Turn on the guest network with its own name and password, and make sure guest access to main-network devices is off. Put visitors and smart gadgets (TV, thermostat, smart plugs) on it. A gadget or two may need setting up again.

Why it matters: Smart gadgets are often the least looked-after devices. If one is compromised, it can't reach your computers or files.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Notes: _____

6 Remote management: off unless you need it

Find remote management or remote access (opening the router's settings from outside your home or office) and turn it off, unless an IT person actually uses it. If your internet provider manages the router, ask them first.

Why it matters: Left on, automated attacks can try common passwords on it from anywhere.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Notes: _____

7 Who's actually connected

Open the list of connected devices (sometimes called Clients) and write each one below. Odd names made of letters and numbers are normal; turn things off one at a time to see which entry disappears. Block anything you can't account for, or change your Wi-Fi password.

Why it matters: Matching every entry to something you own is how you spot a device that shouldn't be there.

Device name	Recognized? Y / N	Action

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

8 Speed, before and after

Run a free speed test before you change anything and again when you finish, using the same device, spot and time of day. Download is how fast things arrive, upload is how fast you send (it matters for video calls), and ping is the delay before data moves.

Why it matters: Treat one test as a snapshot; small differences are usually noise. If results are far below what you pay for, even near the router, ask your internet provider.

	Download (Mbps)	Upload (Mbps)	Ping (ms)
Before			
After			

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

9 Before you close the settings page

Photograph each settings page before you change it. Save the new admin and Wi-Fi passwords in your password manager, and set a reminder to recheck in a few months.

Why it matters: A checkup is a snapshot; the habit is what keeps your network in good shape.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

For small businesses

Separate guest Wi-Fi for customers. Give customers their own guest network and password, never your main one.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Keep business devices off guest Wi-Fi. Payment terminals and point-of-sale (POS) systems, plus office computers, stay on your main network only.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Know who has the admin password. Store it in a password manager, limit who knows it, and change it when staff leave.

☐ Already good ☐ Fixed it ☐ Need help

Your score

Already good	Fixed it	Need help

Stuck on any "Need help" items? NeonKey can do it for you remotely.
See our services at **neonkey.tech/services/** or get in touch at **neonkey.tech/contact/**.